

YOUR WEEKLY MICROSOFT SENTINEL BRIEFING

Sentinel Weekly

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UEBA learns to read your firewalls, table insights turns ingestion into a dashboard, and MDTI stops being a product.

NEW EVERY THURSDAY · CURATED BY PHILLIPE CHAVES DE LIMA

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First clean week: everything below landed between July 31 and August 5. Microsoft published its July roundup on the 31st, the MDTI retirement date arrived on the 1st, and Black Hat filled the middle of the week. Custom detections as code appears in that roundup but was covered in Edition 1, so it does not get a second run here.

On the radar this week

- **UEBA picks up your firewall estate** (*Microsoft Learn, Preview*): More than 40 new FortiGate behaviors, plus ten anomaly rules across Check Point, Fortinet, Zscaler, and identity-linked AWS GuardDuty findings. Third-party network telemetry finally feeds the behavioral layer.
- **Table insights lands in the Defender portal** (*Sentinel Blog*): Per-table ingestion volume, day-over-week fluctuation, last data received, and estimated daily cost, without writing a single KQL query.
- **MDTI is no longer a product** (*Defender XDR Blog*): As of August 1 the standalone Intel pages are retired and the capabilities live in Threat Analytics at no extra cost. Check whether you are still paying for a licence you no longer need.
- **Project Perception hits public preview** (*Microsoft AI*): Red, blue, and green agent classes coordinated by an orchestrator, with Entra Agent ID governance and human approval on consequential actions. Preview opened August 3.

In this edition

Shipped and live now

[UEBA expands to Fortinet, Check Point, Zscaler, and AWS GuardDuty \(Preview\)](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

This is the week's most useful update if you already run UEBA. The behaviors layer now reads Fortinet FortiGate events straight out of CommonSecurityLog, with over 40 behaviors covering administrative activity on the appliances: rapid reconfigurations, config backups, certificate changes, and security service disruptions. They arrive mapped to ATT&CK, including T1685, T1070, T1078, and T1602.002.

Anomaly detection got the wider net. Ten new anomaly rules span Check Point, FortiGate, and Zscaler firewall, VPN, and web proxy events, comparing each user and device against both its own history and organization-wide activity. They cover anomalous and failed VPN sign-ins, unusual access to high-risk web categories, bursts of detections on a potentially compromised device, and suspicious administrative changes, enriched with geolocation, ISP, and threat intelligence context. Identity-linked AWS GuardDuty findings from the AWSGuardDuty table are in as well, and the full list sits in the [UEBA reference](#).

Why it matters in practice: most SOCs have perimeter logs sitting in the workspace doing nothing but cost money and satisfy an auditor. This turns that shelf-ware into behavioral signal without a single custom rule. Worth an hour in your lab this week if FortiGate or Zscaler is in your estate.

[UEBA anomalies on behaviors \(Preview\)](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

Contextual anomaly insights are now attached directly to behavior records, flagging first-seen activity, unusually high behavior volumes, uncommon values, and threat intelligence matches. The point is to stop analysts from manually correlating raw events to answer "is this normal for this user".

[Table insights: ingestion observability without KQL](#) *(Sentinel Blog, July 31)*

Table insights is a panel on the Tables page in the Defender portal under Microsoft Sentinel > Configuration. It gives you 30-day ingestion volume by tier, day-over-week fluctuation against the same day last week, the top five tables by daily volume, last data received per table, estimated daily ingestion cost, and a signed volume anomaly percentage next to each table name.

Two workflows are worth building into your routine immediately. Sort by last data received ascending to catch connectors that went quiet, which is the failure mode nobody notices until an incident needs the data. Then filter to the analytics tier, sort by average daily ingestion descending, and use the cost column to build the tiering business case for anything above a few GB per day with low query usage. Setup guidance sits in [Configure table settings](#).

[Three new connectors](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

GitHub Enterprise audit logs now ingest into Sentinel from Azure Blob Storage with near real-time latency, which requires audit log streaming configured on the GitHub side. Agari brings Brand Protection and Phishing Defense telemetry with DCR-based ingestion-time transformations. Airlock Digital adds application control and execution events for endpoint coverage.

Agentic SOC watch

Project Perception enters public preview *(Microsoft AI, August 3)*

Microsoft's agentic security system opened its public preview on August 3, delivered inside Defender. The architecture is worth understanding even if you are not touching it yet: three classes of agents, red mapping attack paths and vulnerabilities, blue investigating findings and judging what constitutes meaningful risk, green taking corrective action. An orchestrator routes work and a message bus passes context between them. Identity and governance run through Agent 365, and consequential actions still require human approval.

Underneath sits MAI-Cyber-1-Flash, Microsoft's first in-house cybersecurity model, running inside the MDASH vulnerability identification and remediation harness. Microsoft reports a CyberGym score around 96 percent at roughly half the cost of its previous best MDASH configuration. Read those numbers as vendor-run benchmarks, not independent verification.

The SOC-relevant question is not the benchmark. It is what your approval gates look like when a green agent proposes a change in production, and who reviews the audit trail. Start that conversation before the preview reaches your tenant.

Black Hat USA 2026 *(context)*

Microsoft's keynote came from Agentic Security CVP David Weston on August 5, arguing that offense has become cheap enough that rare events are no longer rare. The vendor floor said the same thing in a hundred variations: nearly every major announcement this week was either protection for AI agents or agents doing the protecting. Treat it as a read on where budget conversations go in the next planning cycle.

Next door: Defender XDR and Entra

MDTI convergence is complete *(Defender XDR Blog)*

The final phase went generally available August 1. Standalone MDTI pages, meaning Intel Profiles, Intel Explorer, and Intel Projects, are retired, and the capabilities are reachable through the Threat Analytics tab in the Defender portal at no additional cost. Entity pages for IP addresses, domains, URLs, and files carry a Threat Intelligence Insights tab with reputation data, attributed reports, infrastructure relationships, certificates, DNS and WHOIS records, and sandbox analysis. No migration action is required.

The action item is commercial, not technical: if you or your customer still hold a standalone MDTI licence, that line item is now buying something included elsewhere. Raise it with the account team.

AI agent posture risk in Defender (Preview) *(Microsoft Learn)*

Defender now assesses posture risk for AI agents, covering both enterprise agents and local agents discovered on endpoints. Risk levels build on active indicators such as configuration, access, runtime activity, endpoint and user context, and open alerts, with recommendations to prioritize the risky ones. Pairs naturally with the agent inventory work many teams started this summer.

Domain investigation page is GA *(Microsoft Learn)*

The Active Directory domain investigation page reached general availability: domain properties, deployment health, identity summary, service account breakdown, sensitive entities, active recommendations, group policies, and trust relationships in one view. Quiet feature, real value during an AD-centric investigation where the alternative is four consoles and a PowerShell session.

Email actions moved into advanced hunting *(Microsoft Learn)*

Submit to Microsoft, Add to TABL, and Initiate automated investigation can now be triggered from advanced hunting rather than only from Threat Explorer, which makes them usable from custom queries. Note also that from July 2026 new Defender for Office 365 Plan 2 organizations default to unified RBAC.

The clock to watch

September 30, 2026. The containerized SAP data connector goes out of support. New deployments already only get the agentless connector, billed at the same price, so the only people affected are those still running the container. If SAP is in your scope and the migration is not scheduled yet, this is the quarter to schedule it, not the one to discover it. Microsoft's path is documented in [Migrate to the agentless connector](#).

One query to steal

Table insights will show you a silent connector in the portal. This does the same check as a scheduled rule, so the SOC finds out before the next investigation does. It compares each table's last 24 hours against its own 14-day baseline:

```
union withsource=SourceTable *
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize LastSeen = max(TimeGenerated),
             Recent    = countif(TimeGenerated > ago(1d)),
             Baseline  = countif(TimeGenerated between (ago(14d) .. ago(1d))) / 13.0
  by SourceTable
| where Baseline > 100 and Recent < Baseline * 0.2
| project SourceTable, LastSeen, Recent, ExpectedPerDay = round(Baseline)
| sort by LastSeen asc
// illustrative, validate in your workspace first
// union * is expensive, scope it to your connector tables in production
```

If a table you rely on for detections shows up here, that is a Friday morning problem, not a next-quarter one.

That's Edition 2

If this saved you a browser tab or 12, subscribe and the next one lands every Thursday. Tell me in the comments what Edition 3 should dig into, and send me the stories I missed.

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Curated by Phillippe Chaves de Lima. New every Thursday.